

Optimism. The Essence of Why We Live

As one of India's most proactive corporate luminaries Anand Mahindra, Chairman Mahindra Group, offers an interesting insight into the positivity needed to drive India's future-forward trajectory in a highly disruptive global arena.

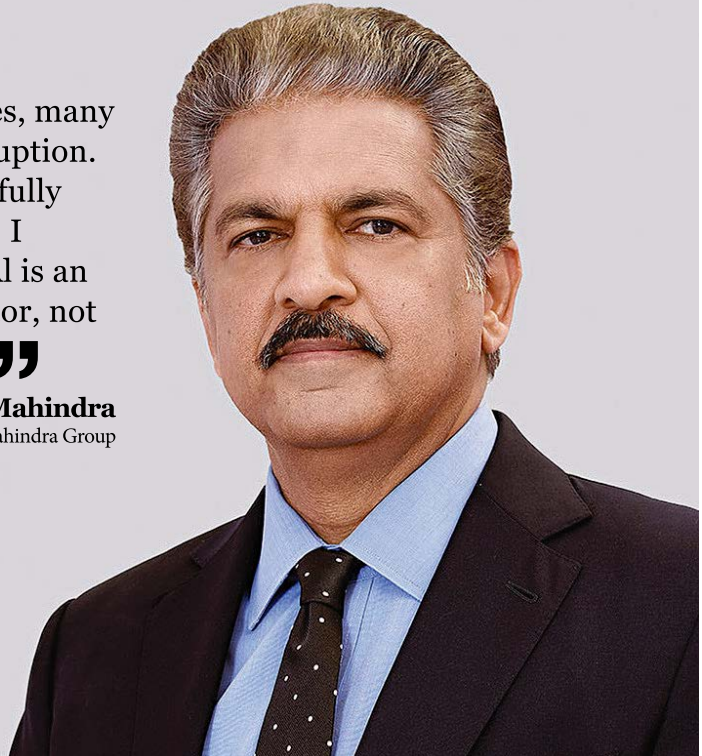
On the cusp of the new year, the seasoned veteran beamed out a message reminding his people that "The world may be unpredictable, with technology evolving and geopolitics shifting. But uncertainty is not our enemy, it is our proving ground." While embracing the reality of AI in shaping the future he put the spotlight on how artificial intelligence, skills and education will shape the Group's next phase. "The start of a new year is the best time to take a deep breath, review the past, and reflect on our readiness for what the future may bring," he pointed out. In his view "As AI reshapes industries, many fear disruption. I respectfully disagree. I believe AI is an accelerator, not a threat." When technology amplifies skilled hands, those hands can become as rewarding, if not more rewarding, than traditional white-collar work. AI can turn blue collar into gold, is how he sees things playing out for the company.

Anand Mahindra is of the firm opinion that India can enhance its economic potential by seizing the opportunity offered by shifting affinities and alliances to become a keystone in the global supply chain system. "We will be less affected by capricious global winds than many other countries. In that context, our Group should have no dearth of opportunities for growth, both domestic and international," he pointed out.

In 1945 his grandfather JC Mahindra co-founded a steel trading company in Mumbai. A third-generation scion of the clan, Anand, who kicked off his journey in 1981 as an Executive Assistant to the Finance Director at Mahindra Ugine Steel Company Ltd

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—Anand Mahindra
Chairman Mahindra Group



(MUSCO), today presides as chair over & Mahindra conglomerate, with a domestic and international spread across 22 industries ranging from auto to IT to aerospace and defense, to real estate and agribusiness.

The group achieved a record high revenue of US\$23 billion, illustrating a 15.81 percent revenue growth up to March 2024. In 2025 alone, market capitalization reached \$50.42 billion, growing 15.53 percent from 2024. Anand was acclaimed by Forbes for having an estimated net worth \$4.3 billion in late November 2025.

Anand from the very start had his sights on a bright career path propelled by insightful decisions and future shaping innovations. It led to his diversification into real estate and hospitality management. Anticipating the potential in finance well ahead of others he became a co-promoter of Kotak Mahindra Bank.

In 2013, he stepped down as a promoter but stayed on as a non-executive director. Then came the pivot towards IT—and its foray as a tech titan. His future forward vision of going green is on a roll as the Group plans a massive investment of \$1.4 billion to develop electric vehicles, and to boost production capacity for EVs and SUVs to 72,000 units per month by March 2026, up from 49,000 units at the end of March this year.

While his corporate endeavours have won him many plaudits Anand remains a progressive humanitarian who stands firmly behind the Nanhi Kali programme, which he initiated two decades ago, providing access to high-quality primary education to over half a million underprivileged girls. Kaabil, in partnership with Mahindra Rise, empowers women jobseekers, especially first-timers, by connecting them to diverse opportunities, local jobs, and skill development resources.